closer together, both before and after the birth of Bangladesh. The only Pakistani leader who understood just how close Indira Gandhi was to Mujib was Zulfi Bhutto, who told Yahya that Mujib was "Indira's puppet" before he flew to Dhaka to try to persuade Mujib to accept his plan.

Nixon's White House had ample telegraphic warnings of the Pakistani army's Dhaka massacre from the State Department's consular officer in East Pakistan, Archer Blood, who witnessed its entire horrible onset. Nixon ignored all of Blood's pleas for humanitarian aid, however, as well as his urging that there be an immediate end to U.S. arms shipments to Pakistan. "Tricky Dick" was preoccupied with his top-secret plans at this time to send Kissinger to China to meet with Chou and Mao as the prelude to his own flight to Beijing to announce U.S. recognition of the People's Republic. While Bangladesh burned and its refugees fled in terror, Kissinger flew first to Islamabad to meet with Yahya, who had set the stage for the Sino-U.S. Friendship Treaty. Zulfi Bhutto's Sino-Pakistani Treaty of Friendship was viewed by Indira Gandhi as a highly ominous potential pincer strategy, aimed at both India's northern tier and the west of the country.

Fearing how dangerous this new U.S.-Pakistan-China alliance could be for India, Mrs. Gandhi launched her own search for international support, flying to Moscow that summer to appeal for help from the Kremlin. On 9 August 1971, Indira signed the twenty-year Treaty of Peace, Friendship, and Cooperation with the Soviet Union, giving her the superpower nuclear cover she required and the heavy military support India needed before moving its army into Bangladesh. Then, that November, she flew to Washington, appealing to Nixon and Kissinger for help to feed and clothe the ten million Bangladeshi refugees who by then ringed Calcutta. Nixon told her only to give Yahya more time to draft a new constitution for Pakistan. So she flew home and gave India's Parsi Field Marshal Sam Manekshaw and his Sikh second-in-command, Lieutenant General Jagjit Singh Aurora, the green light to move east over Bengal's border.

Heavy Soviet artillery and tanks supported India's army as it pushed into Bangladesh, shattering Pakistani resistance completely within a month. Yahya flew Bhutto to Mao and Chou to beg them for support, but they offered him nothing. Nixon sent the nuclear-armed U.S. aircraft carrier *Enterprise* from the Seventh Fleet into the Bay of Bengal, supposedly to "evacuate refugees." All he achieved by that bullying